

Hero Quest Prompt Recipe

The short version: start with a playable mockup, turn it into reusable atlases, then create animation-ready character references. These are the key user prompts from the build.

[Watch the build](#)[Open the cheatsheet](#)[Play the demo](#)

[Mockup](#)[Tile Atlas](#)[UI Atlas](#)[Backgrounds](#)[Hero](#)[Orc](#)[Splash](#)[Audio](#)

1. Find The Game Look

Do not ask for a pretty illustration. Ask for a simple game screen with readable mechanics, reusable platform shapes, and one enemy.

MOCKUP CANDIDATES

```
$imagegen to create 4 mockups that would serve well to visualise this scene.  
try to consider 4 different themes  
e.g., one could be a 'prototype robot theme' where everything feels like a lab / grid , another could be a hero quest theme, etc.
```

REJECT NON-GAME OUTPUTS

```
1 and 2 are what i'm talking about,  
3 looks 3d - nope  
4 looks more like a picture  
  
let's do 2 more alternates, more like 1 and 2 in terms of its gaminess
```

CONSTRAIN THE PLATFORM GRAMMAR

```
let's generate more mock ups, but really focus on keeping things simple.  
so reachable platforms should not have much depth and should be standalone.  
have a fixed number of platform types, etc.  
imagine you have a fixed atlas tile set
```

ADD ONE ENEMY

```
this is great, perhaps now at least include 1 appropriate enemy  
i like the theme of 1 and 2 so continue using those
```

2. Turn The Mockup Into A Gameplay Atlas

The atlas needs whole platforms for fast placement and repeatable tiles for level construction.

GAMEPLAY ATLAS

\$imagegen to create a chroma atlas of assets used based on this mockup
needs whole platforms that can be placed
and repeatable tiles that can be tiled
key props and objects

TRANSPARENT ATLAS

now make a transparent version \$imagegen

CHARACTER REFERENCES

\$imagegen can we have a standalone image of the character and one of the enemy? to serve as reference images for further development

3. Generate UI That Can Be Driven At Runtime

The important trick is to leave fill areas transparent so health and coin progress can be controlled by code.

UI ATLAS

ok great, based on [Image #1], let's use \$imagegen to generate a ui elements atlas that we can have for the game
player portrait + health bar that is dynamically filled (so a transparent bar area)
we should have variants of the portraits – healthy, hurt, worn out (low health), defeated (x_x).
we should also consider how we show the coin collections

MANIFEST REQUIREMENT

for both atlases, let's have a manifest.json that outlines the name, bounds, etc.

4. Build Parallax Layers

Far and mid layers should be light and non-distracting. Foreground should sit at the bottom and tile horizontally.

PARALLAX LAYER SET

see our [Image #1] , let's now do a background test gym,
we want to have parallax in our level, so you have to have images of the right resolution that can be layered on each other for far, medium, and foreground.

make sure that the colors used in far and medium are lighter to not clash with what will go into the main game platforms/characters/props.

the foreground will also be of a different hue/saturation to not distract from the main game, but would sit in front, between the main game and the camera.

\$imagegen to create these images and then put them in the background scene have adjustments in the debug panel to allow us to shift them up/down/left/right or scale them, and to be able to save them to configs too.

REGENERATE WITH TILING CONSTRAINTS

several issues

1. the mid ground has no opacity, so it just blocks the far ground – it really shouldn't the sky, etc.
2. the foreground has artifacts floating in the middle etc. it should really be pegged to the bottom of the screen with no floating elements.
3. the images do not tile horizontally nicely.

regenerate \$imagegen

5. Create The Hero Anchor And Animations

The useful direction was simple: preserve the chibi mockup identity, avoid crouch, make attack a punch, keep idle still.

ANCHOR AND ANIMATION SET

```
ok let's do the anchor and the animations
we don't need crouch
the attack should be a punch
use the cursor sdk with prompts
can we store the results/runs in this repo?
```

USE CHROMA VERSIONS

```
ok let's not pass in transparent bgs for now, give chroma versions,
there's a bug in the cli that tries to create a faux transparent bg
let's do a new run for the anchore
```

PARALLEL ANIMATION BATCH

```
let's generate the animations now using the sdk
make sure to use a simple prompt and parallelise so we can test the sdk
```

IMPROVE IDLE, JUMP, WALK

```
idle looks like he's doing push ups, make it less movement
jump looks too much, hands in the air etc. make it
add walk too
do as a new run
```

STANDING IDLE

```
no we want video modle, but we want a simpler prompt for idle so standing
still
```

The final hero pass used a V2 reference and kept the idle separate from the action batch so the character would actually stand still.

6. Add The Purple Orc

Green enemies fought the green chroma workflow. The usable enemy became a non-green purple orc with a sword.

INTEGRATE ENEMY CHARACTER

ok cool now please let's integrate an enemy character

```
/Users/chong-u/Projects/vgd-phaser-starter/spriterrific-sdk/animation-runs/20260527T135021Z-round3-enemy-v3-purple-orc-actions-w (no run)
```

```
/Users/chong-u/Projects/vgd-phaser-starter/spriterrific-sdk/animation-runs/20260527T142703Z-round3-enemy-v3-purple-orc-run-sword-locked-w (run)
```

add to assets.json, add to the character gym as a drop down, where we can set the same things with the bounds

then integrate into the playground, with the level editor being able to add 'actors'

ENEMY AI

let's do ai for the orc

1. he patrols around, stops for a while and continues patrolling
2. he doesn't walk off ledges
3. if he detects the player and is on the same platform, he will run to the player.
4. after an attempted hit, there is a cooldown, then he continues.

7. Splash And Game Identity

The splash screen should sell the game immediately, then let the player press a key or tap to begin.

SPLASH CANDIDATES

`$imagegen` to generate 4 splash screen candidates for our game using our character, orc and overall assets as source images, but creating something stylised for the splash screen.

Rename it to 'Hero Quest' and remove any internal descriptions from the menu
also in game doesn't need the in game hp, speed, etc. as that's all in the debug

USE CHOSEN CANDIDATE

candidate 2 is the best, so let's use that as the splash image

8. Music And Sound Effects

Audio should reinforce the bright fantasy platformer tone: coins sparkle, punches feel soft and readable, the portal feels magical.

THEME AND SFX

now let's integrate appropriate theme music into our game `$music`
add `$sound-effects` across the board for the main gameplay aspects – recognising the specific characters, items, objects and theme of our game.

Watch the video, use the cheatsheet, then adapt the prompts for your own platformer, RPG,

fighter, or arcade prototype.